REIMAGINING THE WAY WE WORK

Top HR executives discussed ways to align the workforce to the challenges of the digital era at the 'India Today HR Insights: The Future of Work' event held in Bengaluru on June 27

By Ajay Sukumaran

The world of business is getting increasingly complex, largely owing to technological disruptions. Globally, organisations are re-examining how they run their businesses so that they can cater to the growing needs of the digital era. India has already entered this phase, and has an ambitious target of growing into a $1 trillion digital economy by 2028. The Centre has approved a Rs 10,000 crore artificial intelligence (AI) mission to set up cutting-edge, scalable AI computing infrastructure.

These developments will create new challenges in dealing with the workforce. It becomes necessary not only to hire and retain talent that can deal with the changing aspirations of customers, but to also tackle emerging issues on the employee front—matters related to staff burnout, lack of appreciation, or employee development. The hybrid work pattern, where employees juggle between working remotely and being at the office, adds to the complexity.

The INDIA TODAY HR Insights in Bengaluru brought together some of the top human resources (HR) executives in the country for a brainstorming event on 'The Future of Work'.



Richard Lobo, *Chief People Officer, Tech Mahindra*

▼ SCALING AT SPEED: THRIVING IN THE DIGITAL AGE THROUGH BETTER PEOPLE STRATEGIES

"Many of our processes are some 20–30 years old and we hang on to them for various reasons.... So I think we have to now rethink... the only way to go forward is to break some of these things. If we don't consciously break them, we won't move forward"

TAKEAWAYS

- India is poised to become one of the best sources of manpower, technical talent and innovation
- As businesses become more process-driven, it is essential to make workplaces more human. We need to discard old business processes that cause friction

▼ MEETING THE TALENT DEMAND

TAKEAWAYS

- Demand-supply gap for talent is an ongoing challenge
- At least 30 per cent of technical jobs cannot find the right fit, given the gap between the skills in demand and those on offer

"To fill the skill gap, we look for companies to set up their centres of excellence....We find out from companies what they look for and train (students)...and design our own curriculum to match corporate expectations"



Dr John Bruce, *Dean, Placements and Corporate Affairs, Sathyabama Institute of Science and Technology*

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